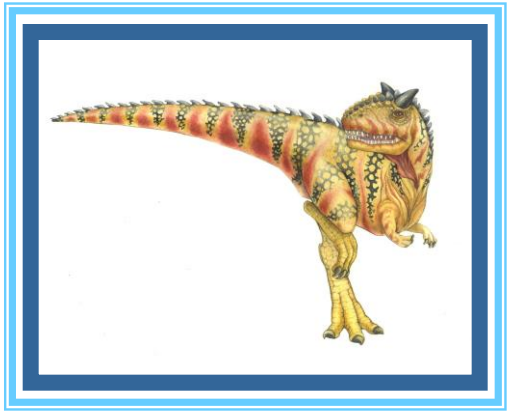
MODULE-1



Silberschatz, Galvin and Gagne ©2013



What is an Operating System?

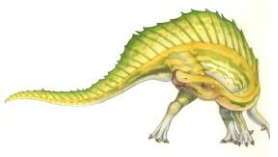
- A program that acts as an intermediary between a user of a computer and the computer hardware
- Operating system goals:
  - Execute user programs and make solving user problems easier
  - Make the computer system convenient to use
  - Use the computer hardware in an efficient manner





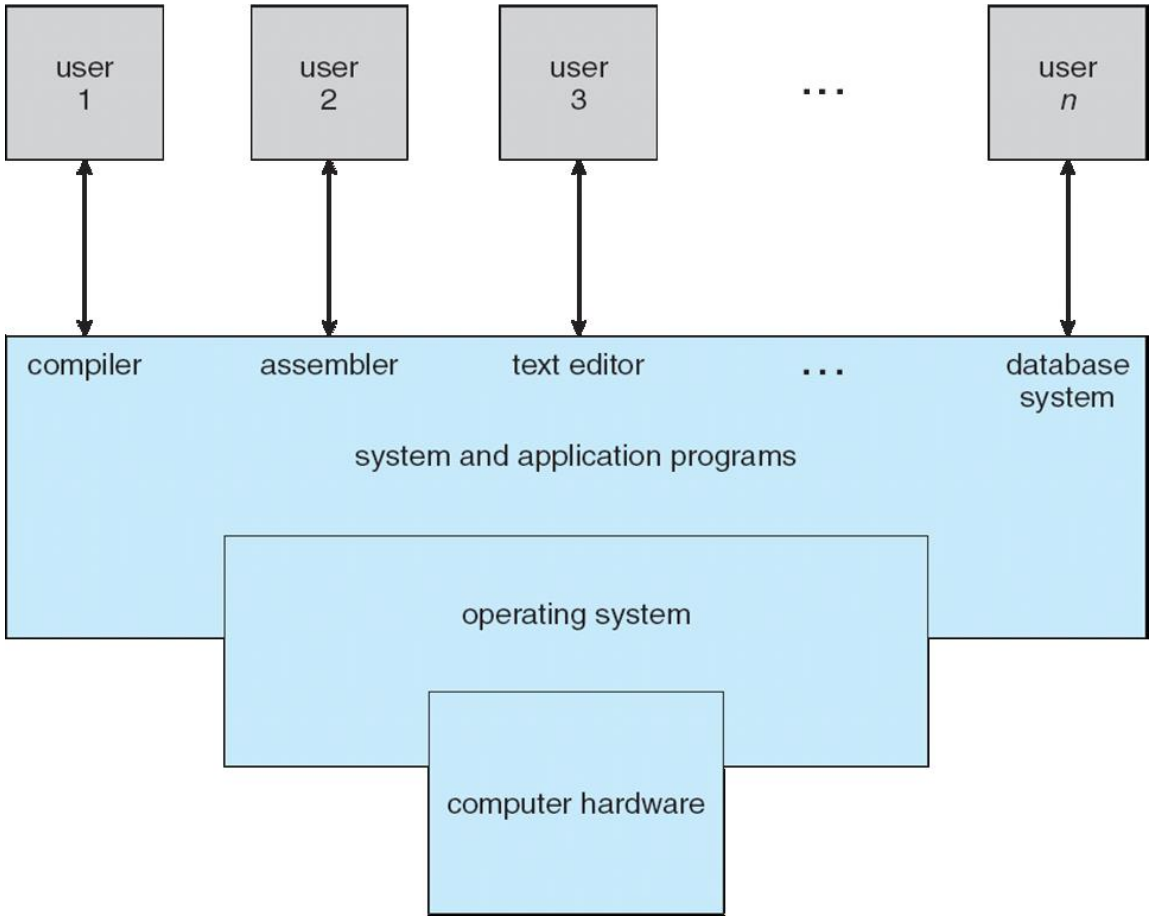
Computer System Structure

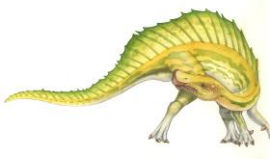
- Computer system can be divided into four components:
  - Hardware – provides basic computing resources
    - CPU, memory, I/O devices
  - Operating system
    - Controls and coordinates use of hardware among various applications and users
  - Application programs – define the ways in which the system resources are used to solve the computing problems of the users
    - Word processors, compilers, web browsers, database systems, video games
  - Users
    - People, machines, other computers





Four Components of a Computer System







What Operating Systems Do

Depends on the point of view:

User View:

- Users want convenience, **ease of use** and **good performance**
  - Don't care about **resource utilization**
- But shared computer such as **mainframe** or **minicomputer** must keep all users happy
- Users of dedicate systems such as **workstations** have dedicated resources but frequently use shared resources from **servers**
- Handheld computers are resource poor, optimized for usability and battery life
- Some computers have little or no user interface, such as embedded computers in devices and automobiles

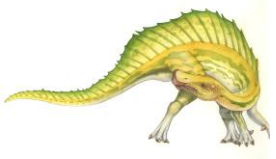




What Operating Systems Do (Cont.)

System View:

- OS is a **resource allocator**
  - Manages all resources
  - Decides between conflicting requests for efficient and fair resource use
- OS is a **control program**
  - Controls execution of programs to prevent errors and improper use of the computer





Operating System Definition

- No universally accepted definition
- "Everything a vendor ships when you order an operating system" is a good approximation
  - But varies wildly
- "The one program running at all times on the computer" is the **kernel**.
- Everything else is either
  - a system program (ships with the operating system) , or
  - an application program.





Computer Startup

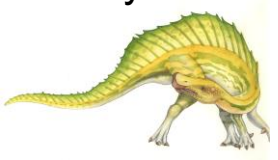
- **bootstrap program** is loaded at power-up or reboot
  - Typically stored in ROM or EPROM, generally known as **firmware**
  - Initializes all aspects of system
  - Loads operating system kernel and starts execution





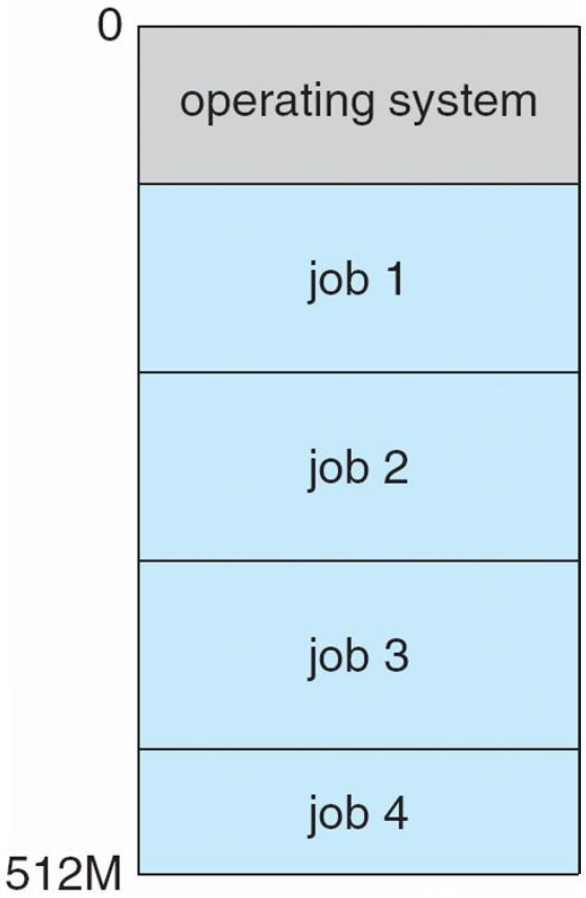
Operating System Structure

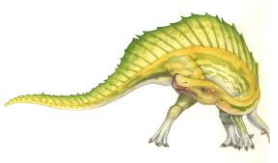
- **Multiprogramming** (**Batch system**) needed for efficiency
  - Single user cannot keep CPU and I/O devices busy at all times
  - Multiprogramming organizes jobs (code and data) so CPU always has one to execute
  - A subset of total jobs in system is kept in memory
  - One job selected and run via **job scheduling**
  - When it has to wait (for I/O for example), OS switches to another job
- **Timesharing** (**multitasking**) is logical extension in which CPU switches jobs so frequently that users can interact with each job while it is running, creating **interactive** computing
  - **Response time** should be < 1 second
  - Each user has at least one program executing in memory ⇨ **process**
  - If several jobs ready to run at the same time ⇨ **CPU scheduling**
  - If processes don't fit in memory, **swapping** moves them in and out to run
  - **Virtual memory** allows execution of processes not completely in memory





Memory Layout for Multiprogrammed System







Operating-System Operations

- **Interrupt driven** (hardware and software)
  - Hardware interrupt by one of the devices
  - Software interrupt (**exception** or **trap):**
    - Software error (e.g., division by zero)
    - Request for operating system service
    - Other process problems include infinite loop, processes modifying each other or the operating system





Operating-System Operations (cont.)

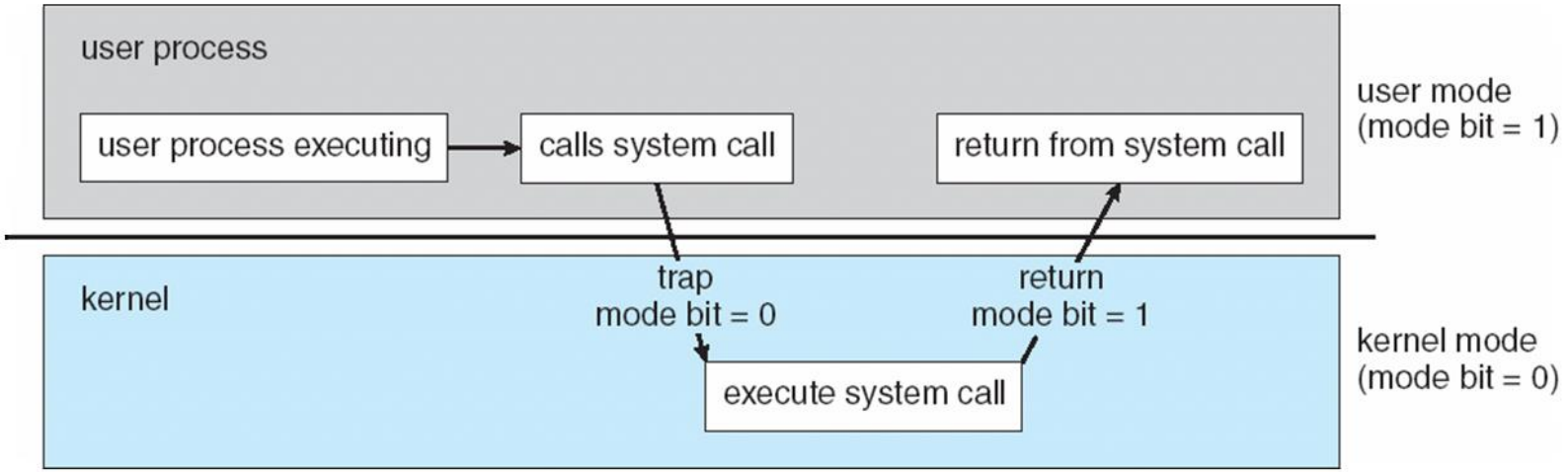
- **Dual-mode** operation allows OS to protect itself and other system components
  - **User mode** and **kernel mode**
  - **Mode bit** provided by hardware
    - Provides ability to distinguish when system is running user code or kernel code
    - Some instructions designated as **privileged**, only executable in kernel mode
    - System call changes mode to kernel, return from call resets it to user
- Increasingly CPUs support multi-mode operations
  - i.e. **virtual machine manager** (**VMM**) mode for guest **VMs**

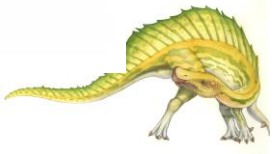




Transition from User to Kernel Mode

- Timer to prevent infinite loop / process hogging resources
  - Timer is set to interrupt the computer after some time period
  - Keep a counter that is decremented by the physical clock.
  - Operating system set the counter (privileged instruction)
  - When counter zero generate an interrupt
  - Set up before scheduling process to regain control or terminate program that exceeds allotted time

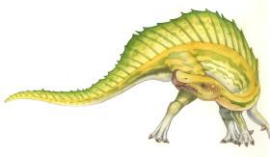






Operating System Services

- Operating systems provide an environment for execution of programs and services to programs and users
- One set of operating-system services provides functions that are helpful to the user:
  - **User interface** - Almost all operating systems have a user interface (**UI**).
    - Varies between **Command-Line (CLI)**, **Graphics User Interface (GUI)**, **Batch**
  - **Program execution** - The system must be able to load a program into memory and to run that program, end execution, either normally or abnormally (indicating error)
  - **I/O operations** - A running program may require I/O, which may involve a file or an I/O device





Operating System Services (Cont.)

- **File-system manipulation** - The file system is of particular interest. Programs need to read and write files and directories, create and delete them, search them, list file Information, permission management.
- **Communications** – Processes may exchange information, on the same computer or between computers over a network
  - Communications may be via shared memory or through message passing (packets moved by the OS)
- **Error detection** – OS needs to be constantly aware of possible errors
  - May occur in the CPU and memory hardware, in I/O devices, in user program
  - For each type of error, OS should take the appropriate action to ensure correct and consistent computing
  - Debugging facilities can greatly enhance the user's and programmer's abilities to efficiently use the system





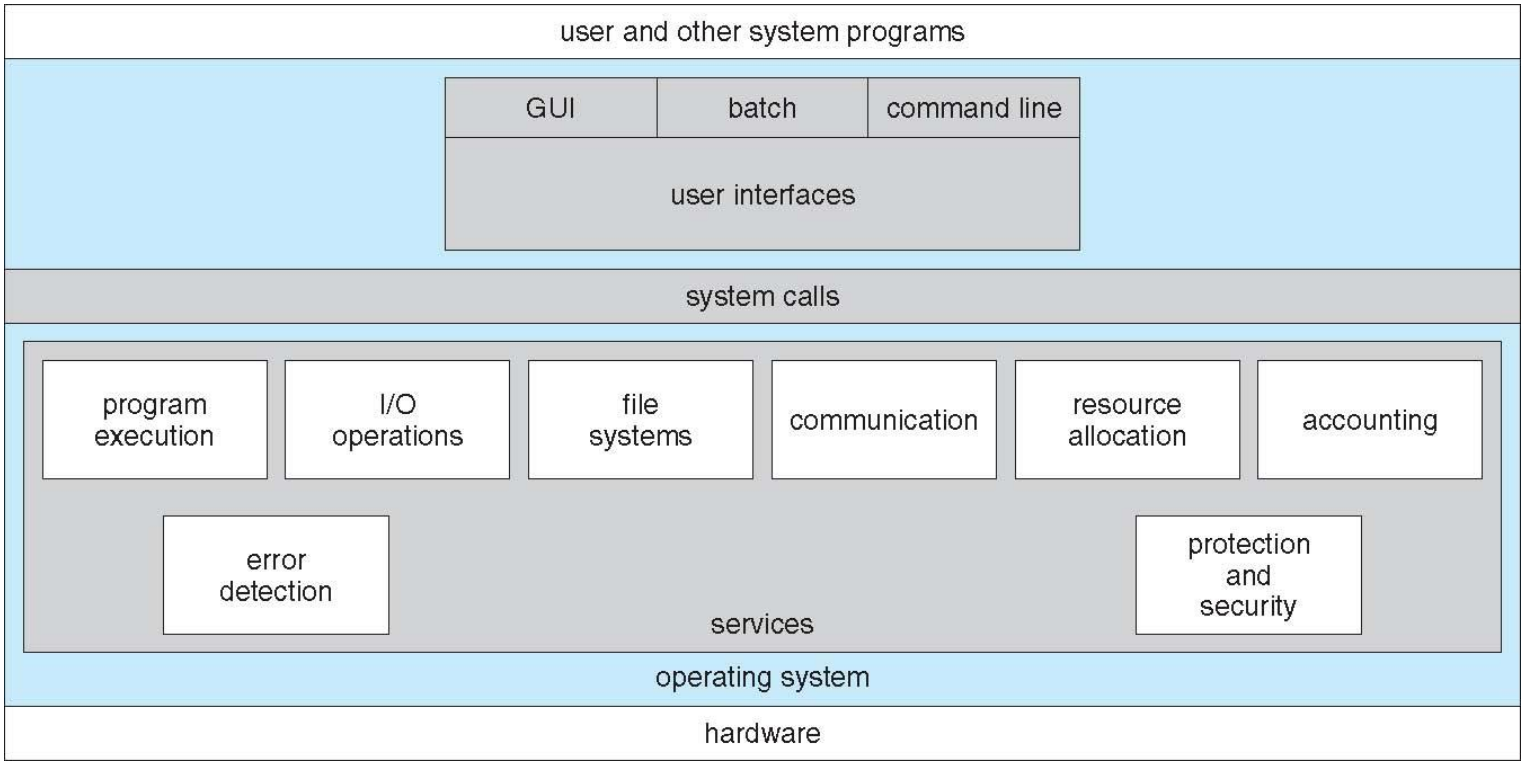
Operating System Services (Cont.)

- Another set of OS functions exists for ensuring the efficient operation of the system itself via resource sharing
  - **Resource allocation -** When multiple users or multiple jobs running concurrently, resources must be allocated to each of them
    - Many types of resources - CPU cycles, main memory, file storage, I/O devices.
  - **Accounting -** To keep track of which users use how much and what kinds of computer resources
  - **Protection and security -** The owners of information stored in a multiuser or networked computer system may want to control use of that information, concurrent processes should not interfere with each other
    - **Protection** involves ensuring that all access to system resources is controlled
    - **Security** of the system from outsiders requires user authentication, extends to defending external I/O devices from invalid access attempts





A View of Operating System Services







User Operating System Interface - CLI

CLI or **command interpreter** allows direct command entry

- Sometimes implemented in kernel, sometimes by systems program
- Sometimes multiple flavors implemented – **shells**
- Primarily fetches a command from user and executes it
- Sometimes commands built-in, sometimes just names of programs
  - If the latter, adding new features doesn't require shell modification





Bourne Shell Command Interpreter

Default

New Info Close Execute Bookmarks

Default Default

```
PBG-Mac-Pro:~ pbg$ w
15:24  up 56 mins, 2 users, load averages: 1.51 1.53 1.65
USER     TTY      FROM              LOGIN@  IDLE WHAT
pbg      console  -                 14:34      50 -
pbg      s000     -                 15:05       - w
PBG-Mac-Pro:~ pbg$ iostat 5
          disk0           disk1          disk10        cpu     load average
    KB/t tps  MB/s     KB/t tps  MB/s     KB/t tps  MB/s  us sy id   1m   5m   15m
   33.75 343 11.30    64.31  14  0.88    39.67   0  0.02  11  5 84  1.51 1.53 1.65
    5.27 320  1.65     0.00   0  0.00     0.00   0  0.00   4  2 94  1.39 1.51 1.65
    4.28 329  1.37     0.00   0  0.00     0.00   0  0.00   5  3 92  1.44 1.51 1.65
^C
PBG-Mac-Pro:~ pbg$ ls
Applications                    Music                           WebEx
Applications (Parallels)        Pando Packages                  config.log
Desktop                         Pictures                        getsmartdata.txt
Documents                       Public                          imp
Downloads                       Sites                           log
Dropbox                         Thumbs.db                       panda-dist
Library                         Virtual Machines                prob.txt
Movies                          Volumes                         scripts
PBG-Mac-Pro:~ pbg$ pwd
/Users/pbg
PBG-Mac-Pro:~ pbg$ ping 192.168.1.1
PING 192.168.1.1 (192.168.1.1): 56 data bytes
64 bytes from 192.168.1.1: icmp_seq=0 ttl=64 time=2.257 ms
64 bytes from 192.168.1.1: icmp_seq=1 ttl=64 time=1.262 ms
^C
--- 192.168.1.1 ping statistics ---
2 packets transmitted, 2 packets received, 0.0% packet loss
round-trip min/avg/max/stddev = 1.262/1.760/2.257/0.498 ms
PBG-Mac-Pro:~ pbg$
```





User Operating System Interface - GUI

- User-friendly **desktop** metaphor interface
  - Usually mouse, keyboard, and monitor
  - **Icons** represent files, programs, actions, etc
  - Various mouse buttons over objects in the interface cause various actions (provide information, options, execute function, open directory (known as a **folder**)
  - Invented at Xerox PARC
- Many systems now include both CLI and GUI interfaces
  - Microsoft Windows is GUI with CLI "command" shell
  - Apple Mac OS X is "Aqua" GUI interface with UNIX kernel underneath and shells available
  - Unix and Linux have CLI with optional GUI interfaces (CDE, KDE, GNOME)





The Mac OS X GUI







Touchscreen Interfaces

- Touchscreen devices require new interfaces
  - Mouse not possible or not desired
  - Actions and selection based on gestures
  - Virtual keyboard for text entry
- Voice commands.







System Calls

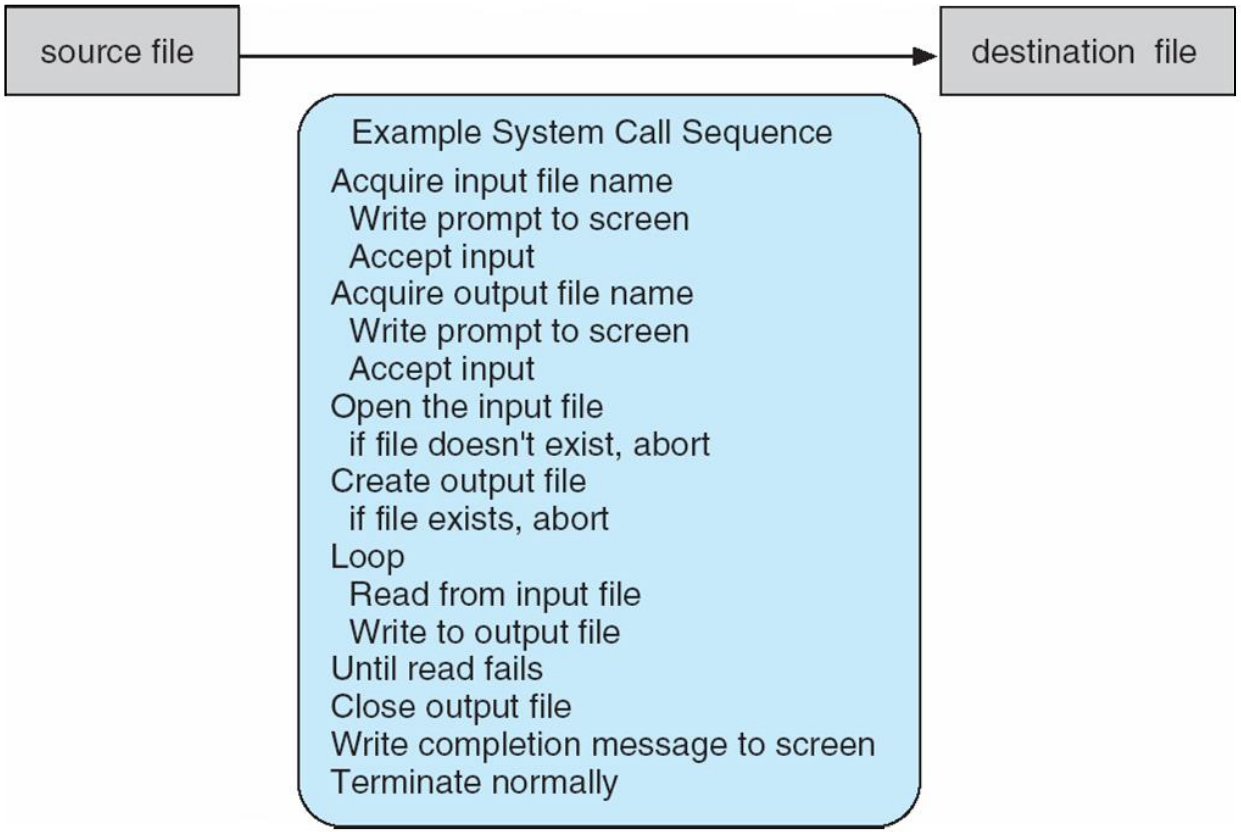
- Programming interface to the services provided by the OS
- Typically written in a high-level language (C or C++)
- Mostly accessed by programs via a high-level **Application Programming Interface (API)** rather than direct system call use
- Three most common APIs are Win32 API for Windows, POSIX API for POSIX-based systems (including virtually all versions of UNIX, Linux, and Mac OS X), and Java API for the Java virtual machine (JVM)

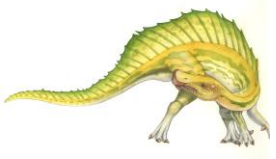




Example of System Calls

- System call sequence to copy the contents of one file to another file







Example of Standard API

EXAMPLE OF STANDARD API

As an example of a standard API, consider the `read()` function that is available in UNIX and Linux systems. The API for this function is obtained from the `man` page by invoking the command

```
man read
```

on the command line. A description of this API appears below:

```
#include <unistd.h>

ssize_t     read(int fd, void *buf, size_t count)
```

return value	function name	parameters

A program that uses the `read()` function must include the `unistd.h` header file, as this file defines the `ssize_t` and `size_t` data types (among other things). The parameters passed to `read()` are as follows:

- `int fd`—the file descriptor to be read
- `void *buf`—a buffer where the data will be read into
- `size_t count`—the maximum number of bytes to be read into the buffer

On a successful read, the number of bytes read is returned. A return value of 0 indicates end of file. If an error occurs, `read()` returns −1.





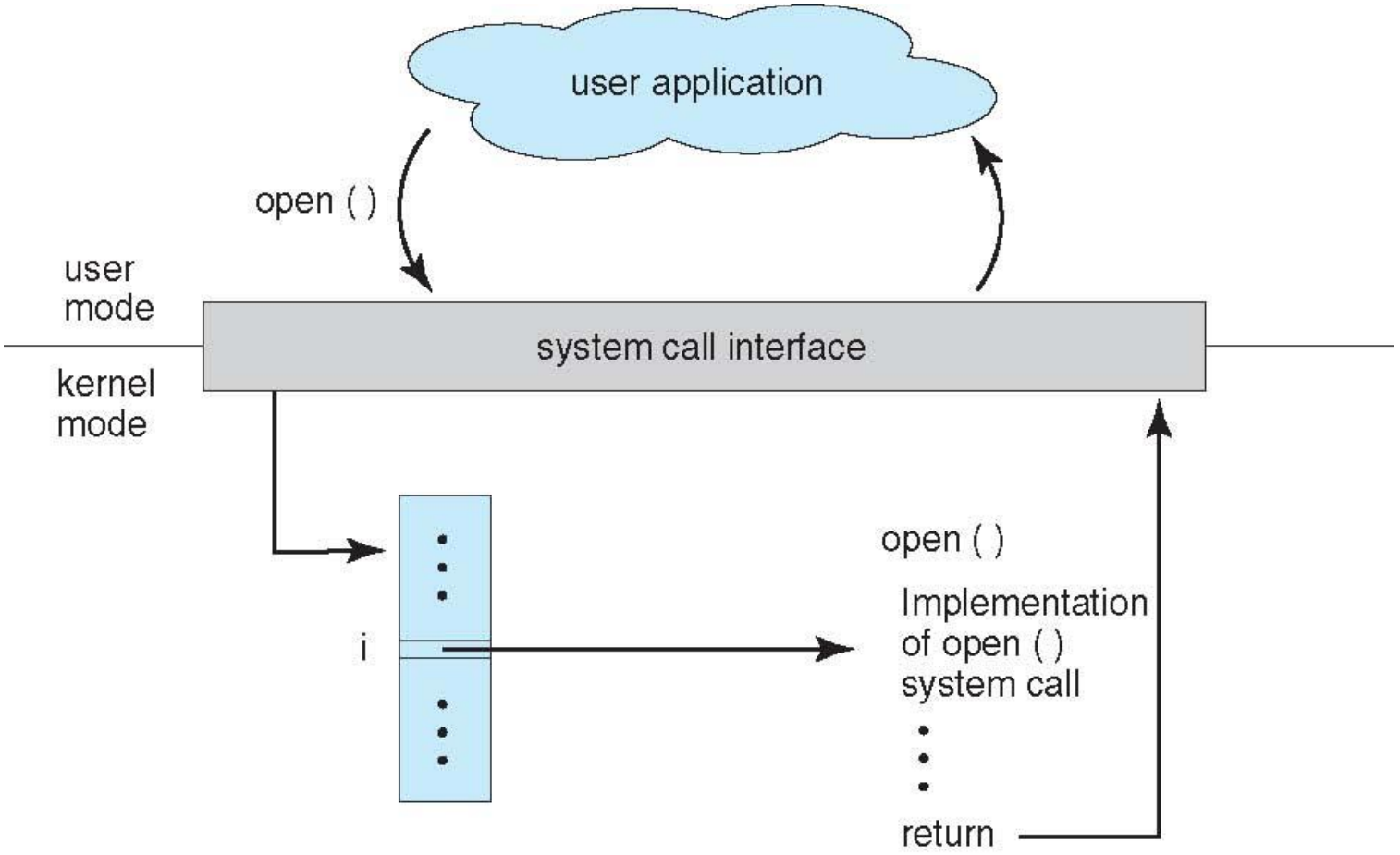
System Call Implementation

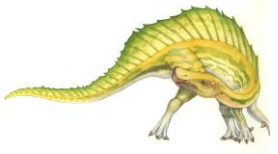
- Typically, a number associated with each system call
  - **System-call interface** maintains a table indexed according to these numbers
- The system call interface invokes the intended system call in OS kernel and returns status of the system call and any return values
- The caller need know nothing about how the system call is implemented
  - Just needs to obey API and understand what OS will do as a result call
  - Most details of OS interface hidden from programmer by API
    - Managed by run-time support library (set of functions built into libraries included with compiler)





API – System Call – OS Relationship







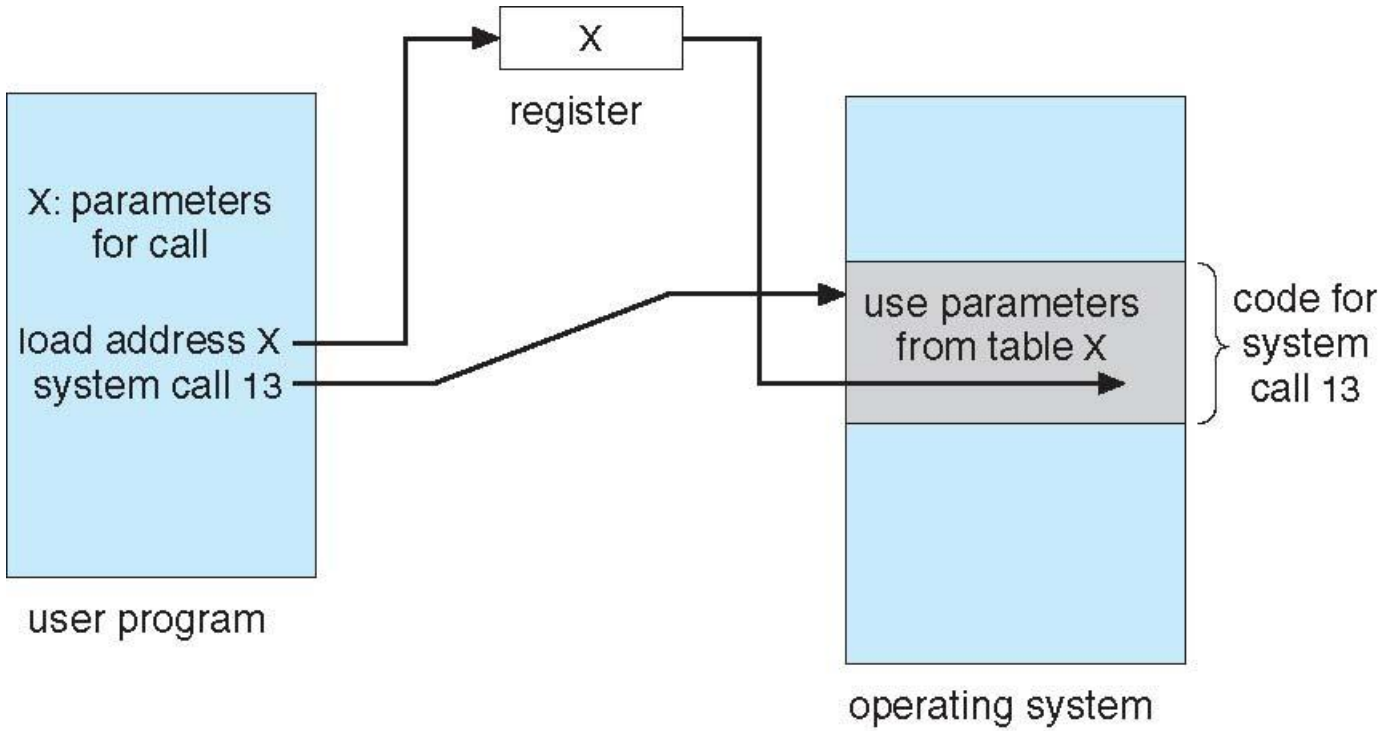
System Call Parameter Passing

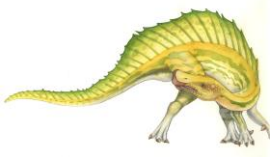
- Often, more information is required than simply identity of desired system call
  - Exact type and amount of information vary according to OS and call
- Three general methods used to pass parameters to the OS
  - Simplest: pass the parameters in registers
    - In some cases, may be more parameters than registers
  - Parameters stored in a block, or table, in memory, and address of block passed as a parameter in a register
    - This approach taken by Linux and Solaris
  - Parameters placed, or **pushed**, onto the **stack** by the program and **popped** off the stack by the operating system
  - Block and stack methods do not limit the number or length of parameters being passed





Parameter Passing via Table







Types of System Calls

- Process control
  - create process, terminate process
  - end, abort
  - load, execute
  - get process attributes, set process attributes
  - wait for time
  - wait event, signal event
  - allocate and free memory
  - Dump memory if error
  - **Debugger** for determining **bugs, single step** execution
  - **Locks** for managing access to shared data between processes





Types of System Calls

- File management
  - create file, delete file
  - open, close file
  - read, write, reposition
  - get and set file attributes
- Device management
  - request device, release device
  - read, write, reposition
  - get device attributes, set device attributes
  - logically attach or detach devices





Types of System Calls (Cont.)

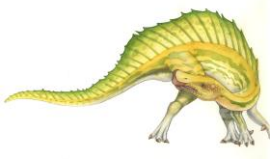
- Information maintenance
  - get time or date, set time or date
  - get system data, set system data
  - get and set process, file, or device attributes
- Communications
  - create, delete communication connection
  - send, receive messages if **message passing model** to **host name** or **process name**
    - From **client** to **server**
  - **Shared-memory model** create and gain access to memory regions
  - transfer status information
  - attach and detach remote devices





Types of System Calls (Cont.)

- Protection
  - Control access to resources
  - Get and set permissions
  - Allow and deny user access





Examples of Windows and Unix System Calls

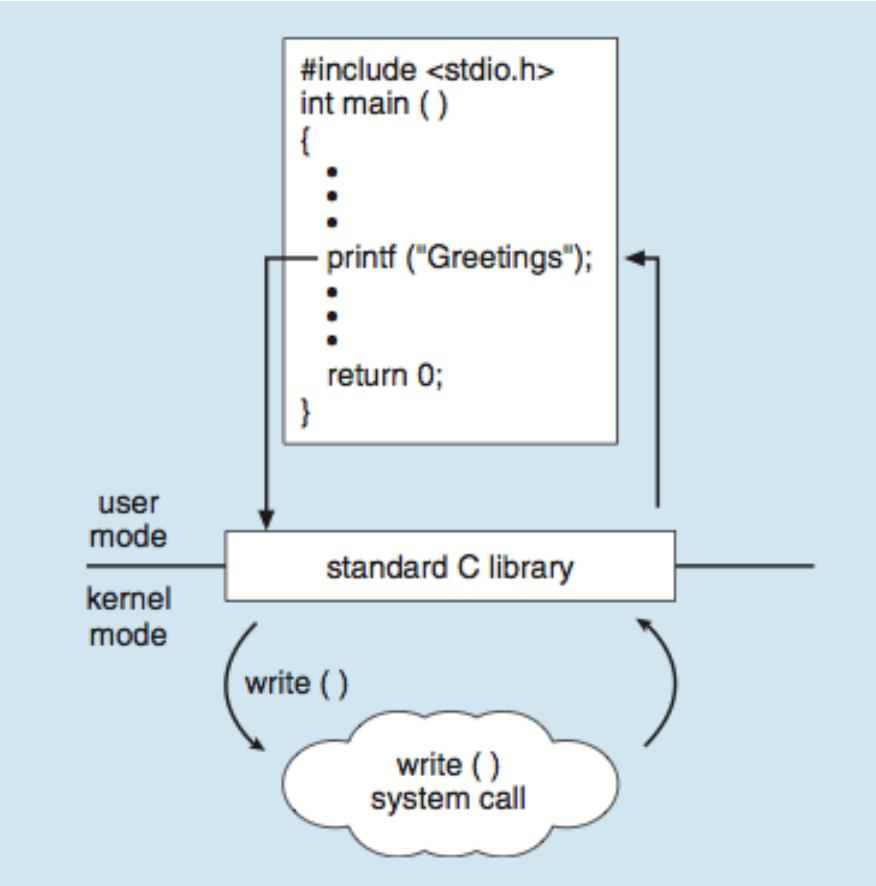
	Windows	Unix
Process Control	CreateProcess() ExitProcess() WaitForSingleObject()	fork() exit() wait()
File Manipulation	CreateFile() ReadFile() WriteFile() CloseHandle()	open() read() write() close()
Device Manipulation	SetConsoleMode() ReadConsole() WriteConsole()	ioctl() read() write()
Information Maintenance	GetCurrentProcessID() SetTimer() Sleep()	getpid() alarm() sleep()
Communication	CreatePipe() CreateFileMapping() MapViewOfFile()	pipe() shmget() mmap()
Protection	SetFileSecurity() InitlializeSecurityDescriptor() SetSecurityDescriptorGroup()	chmod() umask() chown()

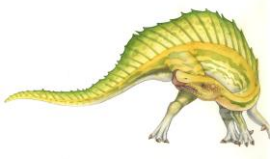




Standard C Library Example

- C program invoking printf() library call, which calls write() system call







System Programs

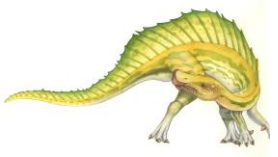
- System programs provide a convenient environment for program development and execution. They can be divided into:
  - File manipulation
  - Status information sometimes stored in a File modification
  - Programming language support
  - Program loading and execution
  - Communications
  - Background services
  - Application programs
- Most users' view of the operation system is defined by system programs, not the actual system calls





System Programs

- Provide a convenient environment for program development and execution
  - Some of them are simply user interfaces to system calls; others are considerably more complex
- **File management** - Create, delete, copy, rename, print, dump, list, and generally manipulate files and directories
- **Status information**
  - Some ask the system for info - date, time, amount of available memory, disk space, number of users
  - Others provide detailed performance, logging, and debugging information
  - Typically, these programs format and print the output to the terminal or other output devices
  - Some systems implement a **registry** - used to store and retrieve configuration information





System Programs (Cont.)

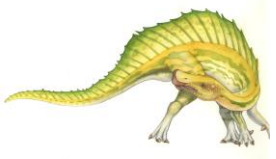
- **File modification**
  - Text editors to create and modify files
  - Special commands to search contents of files or perform transformations of the text
- **Programming-language support** - Compilers, assemblers, debuggers and interpreters sometimes provided
- **Program loading and execution**- Absolute loaders, relocatable loaders, linkage editors, and overlay-loaders, debugging systems for higher-level and machine language
- **Communications** - Provide the mechanism for creating virtual connections among processes, users, and computer systems
  - Allow users to send messages to one another's screens, browse web pages, send electronic-mail messages, log in remotely, transfer files from one machine to another





System Programs (Cont.)

- **Background Services**
  - Launch at boot time
    - Some for system startup, then terminate
    - Some from system boot to shutdown
  - Provide facilities like disk checking, process scheduling, error logging, printing
  - Run in user context not kernel context
  - Known as **services**, **subsystems**, **daemons**
- **Application programs**
  - Don't pertain to system
  - Run by users
  - Not typically considered part of OS
  - Launched by command line, mouse click, finger poke





Operating System Design and Implementation

- Design and Implementation of OS not “solvable”, but some approaches have proven successful
- Internal structure of different Operating Systems can vary widely
- Start the design by defining goals and specifications
- Affected by choice of hardware, type of system
- **User** goals and **System** goals
  - User goals – operating system should be convenient to use, easy to learn, reliable, safe, and fast
  - System goals – operating system should be easy to design, implement, and maintain, as well as flexible, reliable, error-free, and efficient





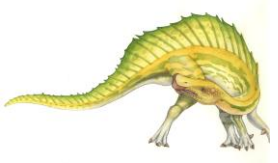
Operating System Design and Implementation (Cont.)

- Important principle to separate

  Policy: ***What*** will be done?

  Mechanism: ***How*** to do it?

- Mechanisms determine how to do something; policies decide what will be done
- The separation of policy from mechanism is a very important principle, it allows maximum flexibility if policy decisions are to be changed later (example – timer)
- Specifying and designing an OS is highly creative task of **software engineering**





Implementation

- Much variation
  - Early OSes in assembly language
  - Then system programming languages like Algol, PL/1
  - Now C, C++
- Actually, usually a mix of languages
  - Lowest levels in assembly
  - Main body in C
  - Systems programs in C, C++, scripting languages like PERL, Python, shell scripts
- More high-level language easier to **port** to other hardware
  - But slower
- **Emulation** can allow an OS to run on non-native hardware





Operating System Structure

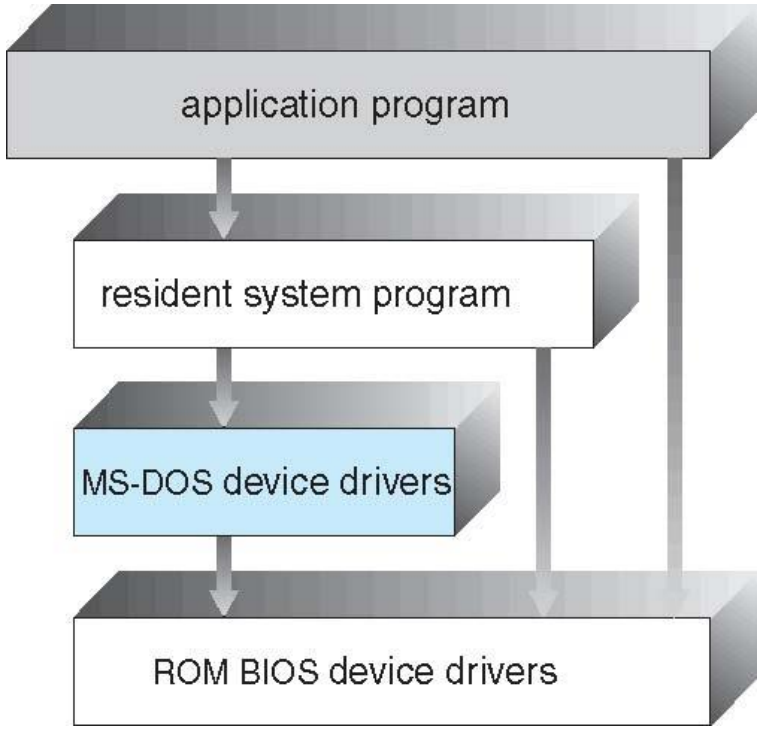
- General-purpose OS is very large program
- Various ways to structure ones
  - Simple structure – MS-DOS
  - More complex – UNIX
  - Layered – an abstraction (Linux)
  - Microkernel – Mach
  - Modular Approach - Solaris

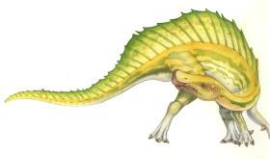




Simple Structure -- MS-DOS

- MS-DOS – written to provide the most functionality in the least space
  - Not divided into modules
  - Although MS-DOS has some structure, its interfaces and levels of functionality are not well separated







Non Simple Structure -- UNIX

UNIX – limited by hardware functionality, the original UNIX operating system had limited structuring. The UNIX OS consists of two separable parts

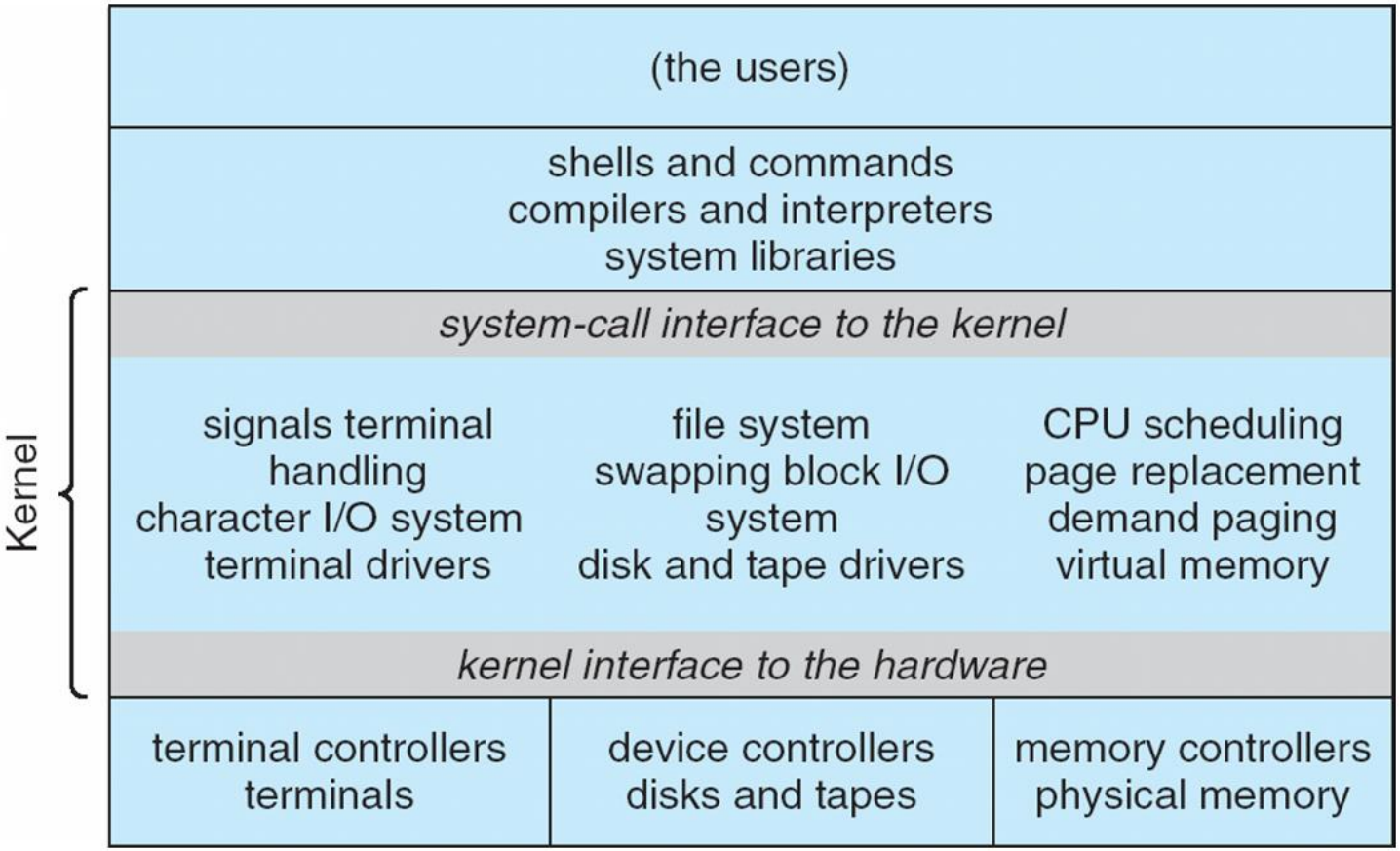
- Systems programs
- The kernel
  - Consists of everything below the system-call interface and above the physical hardware
  - Provides the file system, CPU scheduling, memory management, and other operating-system functions; a large number of functions for one level





Traditional UNIX System Structure

Beyond simple but not fully layered

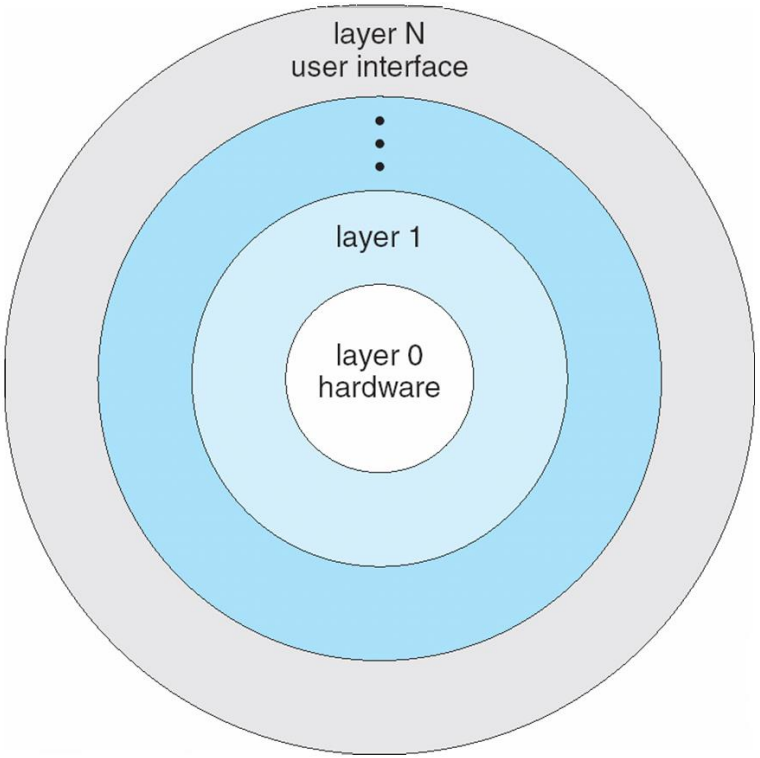


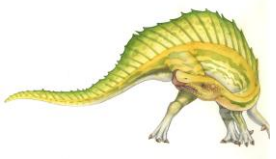




Layered Approach

- The operating system is divided into a number of layers (levels), each built on top of lower layers. The bottom layer (layer 0), is the hardware; the highest (layer N) is the user interface.
- With modularity, layers are selected such that each uses functions (operations) and services of only lower-level layers







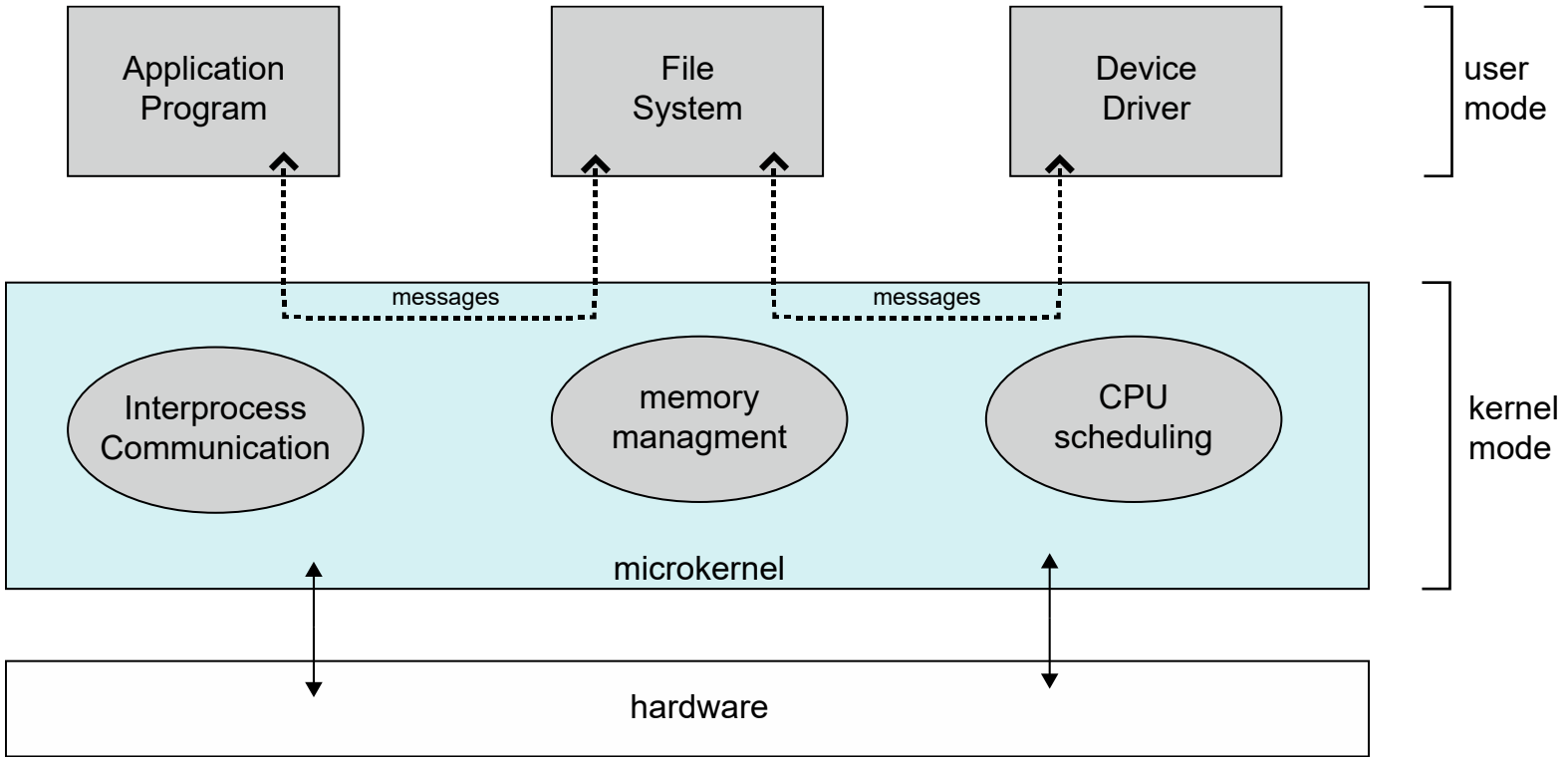
Microkernel System Structure

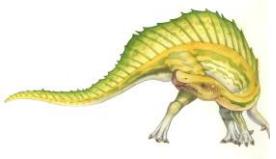
- Moves as much from the kernel into user space
- **Mach** example of **microkernel**
  - Mac OS X kernel (**Darwin**) partly based on Mach
- Communication takes place between user modules using **message passing**
- Benefits:
  - Easier to extend a microkernel
  - Easier to port the operating system to new architectures
  - More reliable (less code is running in kernel mode)
  - More secure
- Detriments:
  - Performance overhead of user space to kernel space communication





Microkernel System Structure

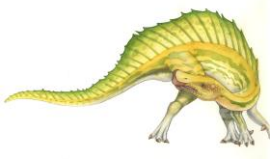






Modules

- Many modern operating systems implement **loadable kernel modules**
  - Uses object-oriented approach
  - Each core component is separate
  - Each talks to the others over known interfaces
  - Each is loadable as needed within the kernel
- Overall, similar to layers but with more flexible
  - Linux, Solaris, etc





Solaris Modular Approach

